Northwind Outfitters

Return & Refund Policy | Effective Date: January 1, 2026 | Last Updated: October 11, 2026

This is a fictional sample policy created for illustration. Northwind Outfitters is not a real business.

1. Overview

We want you to be happy with every purchase from Northwind Outfitters. If something is not right, you may return most items within **30 days** of delivery for a refund, exchange, or store credit, subject to the conditions below. This policy applies to purchases made on www.northwindoutfitters.example and at our retail store located at 450 Maple Avenue, Columbus, OH 43215.

2. Return Window

Item Type	Return Window	Refund Method
Standard merchandise	30 days from delivery	Original payment method
Clearance / final sale items	Not returnable	N/A
Defective or damaged items	90 days from delivery	Replacement or full refund
Gift purchases (with gift receipt)	30 days from delivery	Store credit
Holiday purchases (Nov 1 - Dec 24)	Through January 31	Original payment method

3. Eligibility Requirements

- Items must be unused, unwashed, and in their original condition with all tags and packaging attached.
- A valid proof of purchase (order number, receipt, or packing slip) is required.
- Items must be returned in the original packaging whenever possible.
- Personalized or custom-made items cannot be returned unless defective.
- Opened hygiene products, gift cards, and downloadable software are non-returnable.

4. How to Start a Return

1. Visit www.northwindoutfitters.example/returns and enter your order number and email address, or call us at (614) 555-0142.
2. Select the items you wish to return and choose a reason.
3. Print the prepaid return label (or request a QR code for drop-off at a participating carrier location).
4. Pack the items securely and ship within 7 days of receiving your label.

5. Refunds

Once your return arrives at our warehouse (Northwind Returns Center, 1200 Commerce Drive, Groveport, OH 43125), we will inspect it within **3 business days**. Approved refunds are issued to your original payment method within **5 to 7 business days**, though your bank may take additional time to post the credit. Original shipping charges are non-refundable unless the return is due to our error.

6. Return Shipping Costs

- **Our error** (wrong, damaged, or defective item): free prepaid return label.
- **Change of mind:** a flat $6.95 return shipping fee is deducted from your refund.
- **In-store returns:** always free.

7. Exchanges

To exchange an item for a different size or color, start a return and place a new order for the desired item. This ensures the item you want is reserved. If the price differs, we will refund or charge the difference.

8. Restocking Fees

Standard returns have no restocking fee. Large items (such as tents and kayaks) returned without original packaging are subject to a **15% restocking fee**.

9. Damaged or Incorrect Items

If your order arrives damaged or incorrect, contact us within **14 days** of delivery at returns@northwindoutfitters.example with your order number and a photo of the issue. We will send a replacement or issue a full refund, including original shipping costs.

10. Late or Missing Refunds

If you have not received your refund after 10 business days, first check your bank account, then contact your card issuer. If you still need help, email returns@northwindoutfitters.example.

11. Contact Us

Customer Care Team	Northwind Outfitters
Email	returns@northwindoutfitters.example
Phone	(614) 555-0142
Hours	Monday - Friday, 9:00 AM - 6:00 PM ET
Mailing Address	450 Maple Avenue, Columbus, OH 43215

Northwind Outfitters reserves the right to modify this policy at any time. Changes apply to purchases made after the updated effective date.